

06

Wi-Fi and Network Connectivity

No internet, weak Wi-Fi, wired network drops, DNS and slow connections

Default priority: P2 High if a site or floor is down, otherwise P3

Target response / resolution: Respond in 15 min / resolve in 4 business hours

Handled by: Tier 1, then Network team

Scope

Use this instruction when a user cannot connect to the corporate network or the internet, or the connection is unstable or slow.

Related instructions: WI-07 VPN, WI-16 Meeting Room AV, WI-10 Security Incidents

Common symptoms

- "No internet" or limited connectivity indicator
- Cannot join the corporate Wi-Fi, or keeps disconnecting
- Wired port is dead, or the dock does not give a connection
- Websites or internal apps are slow or time out

Information to collect

- Location (building, floor, desk) and device hostname
- Wi-Fi or wired, and the network name (SSID)
- Whether other users nearby are affected
- Result of a ping to the gateway and to an external site

Resolution steps

- 1 Scope the issue.** Ask nearby users or check the monitoring dashboard. If many users are affected, treat it as an outage and escalate to the Network team at once.
- 2 Check the device.** Confirm Wi-Fi is on and airplane mode is off. Toggle the adapter, then restart the device. Check that the IP address is valid and is not a 169.254.x.x address.
- 3 Test layer by layer.** Ping the default gateway, then a public IP address, then a domain name. Failure at the gateway means local connection, at the public IP means routing or the firewall, and at the name means DNS.
- 4 Reset the connection.** Forget and rejoin the Wi-Fi network, renew the IP lease, flush DNS, and reset the network stack. Update the network adapter driver if outdated.
- 5 Check the physical layer.** For wired problems, swap the cable, try another wall port and another dock, and check the port in the switch management tool.
- 6 Try an alternative.** Test on another known-good device or another network (for example a mobile hotspot, if policy allows) to see if the fault follows the user or the location.
- 7 Confirm stable connection.** Verify access to the internet, an internal application, and a file share. Watch for a few minutes to confirm there are no drops.

Escalate when

- Multiple users or a whole location affected
- Faulty switch port, wireless access point, or cabling
- Suspected unauthorized device or rogue access point on the network (see WI-10)

Resolution and closure

- Record the location, root cause, and any port or access point involved
- Close after the user confirms stable connectivity

Quick troubleshooting reference

Symptom	Likely cause	What to do
Connected to Wi-Fi but no internet	DNS problem, captive portal, or upstream fault	Ping the gateway and a public IP. Flush DNS and test another device.
Wi-Fi drops every few minutes	Weak signal, roaming issue, or driver	Check signal strength, move closer to the access point, update the driver, and report the location.
169.254.x.x address	DHCP failure	Renew the lease, try another port or SSID, and escalate to the Network team if it spreads.
Wired port dead	Cable, port, or switch configuration	Swap the cable, try another wall port, and check the switch port status.
Internal sites slow, internet fine	Routing or server issue	Test from another device and location. Escalate with timings and trace results.

Suggested wording for the user

Open	<i>"Are your colleagues nearby affected too? That tells me whether it is your device or the network."</i>
During	<i>"I am running a few tests to see where the connection drops. Please keep the laptop where it is."</i>
Close	<i>"You are back online. If it drops again, please note the time and your location, and call us with this ticket number."</i>

Good practice

Do

- Ask how many people are affected before deep troubleshooting
- Test layer by layer: gateway, IP, name
- Record location and access point name
- Check monitoring dashboards early

Do not

- Do not reset network equipment without approval
- Do not tell users to use personal hotspots for sensitive work unless policy allows
- Do not close an outage ticket without monitoring it for stability
- Do not guess; capture test results

Worked example

Four users on the third floor report the Wi-Fi disconnecting during meetings.

Ticket note field	Entry
Issue reported	Wi-Fi drops several times an hour on floor 3, east side.
Checks performed	Monitoring shows one access point rebooting. Other floors normal.
Cause	Faulty access point.
Action taken	Linked to the Network team. They replaced the unit. Users advised to rejoin the network.
Result	No further drops over 24 hours. Incident closed.

Analyst checklist

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|---|--|
| ☐ Scope the issue | ☐ Try an alternative |
| ☐ Check the device | ☐ Confirm stable connection |
| ☐ Test layer by layer | ☐ Ticket note completed using the standard template |
| ☐ Reset the connection | ☐ User confirmed the issue is resolved |
| ☐ Check the physical layer | |

Preventing repeat tickets

- Run regular wireless surveys
- Keep spare access points and cables
- Monitor DHCP pool usage
- Label wall ports and keep a port map